

Dealing with conflict

Gaining a deeper understanding of their own and others' boundaries is a vital aspect of growing up for teens, but this can lead to family arguments. It is natural for people in close relationships to argue, but both teens and parents can learn techniques to defuse conflict.

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Arguments

Arguments occur when people feel that they or their needs have been misunderstood, or that they have not been heard. Often, people find themselves in a heated argument over something trivial, but with an underlying issue that is difficult to talk about. As teens explore and experiment with ideas and values other than those of their parents, they are also generally less willing to accept a parent's opinion as the last word on a subject.

▽ Sticking points

During adolescence, teens and parents may find that they disagree about all sorts of issues.

PARENT TIPS

Avoiding escalation

- Decide whether this is an argument you want to have. Often, teens just want to get something off their chest, and your best response is to listen and show understanding for their frustration. Also, by letting some things go, your teen will recognize that when you do take a stand, you mean it.
- Avoid arguing in the heat of the moment. Let your teen know that you value their opinion, but that both of you need to be calmer and may need more time to think the issue through.
- Try not to raise your voice. Shouting can be interpreted as a loss of control, and your teen will either shout back or shut down.



appearance



friends



chores



respect



bad habits



politics



rules



homework